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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to protect Northstar Financial Solutions' information systems and company data from unauthorized access, disclosure, modification, and destruction.

All employees are expected to follow company security practices and protect information entrusted to the organization.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees who use company systems, applications, or devices.

Contractors, temporary workers, and third-party service providers must follow applicable company security requirements when accessing company systems.

3. Access Control

Employees must use their assigned accounts to access company systems.

Employees should only have access to the information and systems necessary to perform their job duties.

Managers are responsible for requesting appropriate access for their employees.

The IT department creates user accounts and assigns access permissions.

Access permissions should be reviewed periodically to ensure employees retain appropriate access.

4. Password Management

Employees must create strong passwords and avoid sharing passwords with other individuals.

Passwords should be changed when employees believe their accounts may have been compromised.

Employees should not write passwords in locations where unauthorized individuals can easily access them.

5. Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-factor authentication should be used when available, particularly for systems containing sensitive information.

The IT department is responsible for implementing authentication measures appropriate to the systems it manages.

6. Data Protection

Employees must protect confidential company information from unauthorized disclosure.

Sensitive information should only be shared with authorized individuals who have a legitimate business need.

Employees should use approved company systems when storing or transmitting sensitive information.

7. Encryption

Sensitive information should be encrypted when necessary to protect it from unauthorized access.

The IT department determines which systems require encryption based on business needs.

8. Vulnerability and Patch Management

The IT department is responsible for maintaining system security and installing software updates.

Critical security updates should be installed as soon as reasonably possible.

The IT department may delay updates when operational requirements make immediate installation difficult.

9. Security Awareness Training

Employees should receive security awareness training to help them recognize phishing attempts, protect company information, and follow security procedures.

Managers are encouraged to remind employees about security risks when appropriate.

10. Incident Reporting

Employees must report suspected security incidents to the IT department.

The IT department investigates reported incidents and takes appropriate corrective action.

Employees should provide relevant information to assist with investigations.

11. Third-Party Security

Third-party service providers must comply with applicable contractual security requirements.

The IT department is responsible for evaluating third-party security risks when necessary.

12. Policy Compliance

Employees who fail to follow this policy may be subject to disciplinary action.

The IT department is responsible for monitoring compliance with this policy.

13. Policy Review

This policy should be reviewed periodically to ensure it remains appropriate for the organization.

The Chief Information Officer may approve changes to this policy when necessary.

End of Policy